

UJJAIN COMPLETE PILGRIMAGE GUIDE

Mahakaleshwar Jyotirlinga · Harsiddhi Shakti Peetha · Sacred Shipra

Published by nalkheda.in | WhatsApp: +91 97547 09571

About Ujjain

Ujjain (ancient Avantika) is one of India's 7 sacred cities (Sapta Puri) and the spiritual capital of Madhya Pradesh. Located on the banks of the holy Shipra river, it is home to one of the 12 Jyotirlingas — the Mahakaleshwar temple — and one of the 51 Shaktipeethas — Maa Harsiddhi. The city is also famous for the Kumbh Mela held every 12 years. Ujjain serves as the ideal base for the complete MP Pilgrimage Circuit: Nalkheda (100 km) and Omkareshwar (130 km).

One of 7 Sacred Cities	Jyotirlinga #7	Shipra River	Kumbh Mela City
Sapta Puri	Dakshinamukhi Shiva	2,500+ years old	Every 12 years

MAJOR TEMPLES OF UJJAIN

■ MAHAKALESHWAR JYOTIRLINGA JYOTIRLINGA #7	The most sacred temple of Ujjain — one of 12 Jyotirlingas and the only south-facing (Dakshinamukhi) Shiva lingam. The Bhasma Aarti at 4AM uses sacred ash in an ancient Tantric ritual. Pre-book online at mahakaleshwar.com. Timings: 4AM–11PM.
■ MAA HARSIDDHI SHAKTI PEETHA SHAKTI PEETHA	One of 51 Shaktipeethas where Sati's elbow fell. Famous for two massive oil lamps (deepmalas) lit on Navratri. King Vikramaditya is said to have offered his head here 11 times. Timings: 6AM–10PM.
■ KAAL BHAIRAV TEMPLE TANTRIC TEMPLE	The fierce guardian deity of Ujjain. Unique tradition of offering liquor (madira) as prasad — the idol is said to consume it. A powerful Tantric experience. Timings: 6AM–10PM.
■ MANGALNATH TEMPLE NAVGRAHA	Birthplace of planet Mars (Mangal Graha) per Hindu cosmology. Essential for those with Mangal dosha. Special puja performed on Tuesdays. Located on Shipra river bank. Timings: 5AM–9PM.
■ SANDIPANI ASHRAM HISTORICAL	The legendary gurukul where Lord Krishna, Balaram and Sudama studied. The stone slab on which Krishna wrote lessons is preserved here. Open: 8AM–7PM.
■ RAM GHAT — SHIPRA RIVER SACRED GHAT	Most sacred ghat on Shipra. Evening aarti rivals Varanasi's Ganga Aarti. Kumbh Mela held here every 12 years (next: 2028). Sacred bath at dawn recommended.
■ BADA GANESH MANDIR FIRST DARSHAN	First darshan of the Ujjain circuit — start your yatra here for Ganesha's blessings. Located near the Mahakaleshwar main gate. Open all day.
■ GADKALIKA TEMPLE SHAKTI TEMPLE	Ancient Shakti temple linked to poet Kalidas who was blessed by the goddess here. Beautiful architecture. Near Shipra river. Timings: 6AM–9PM.

HOW TO REACH UJJAIN

✈️ ■ By Air	Nearest airport: Devi Ahilyabai Holkar Airport, Indore (~55 km). Flights from Delhi, Mumbai
■ By Train	Ujjain Junction is excellently connected. Trains from Delhi (~10 hrs), Mumbai (~12 hrs), Bh
■ By Road	Delhi: ~780 km via NH 52. Mumbai: ~660 km via NH 3. Bhopal: ~185 km. Indore: ~55 km. S
■ To Nalkheda	From Ujjain: ~100 km, ~2 hours by cab. ■1,800–2,500. Day trip possible. WhatsApp +91 9
■ To Omkareshwar	From Ujjain: ~130 km, ~2.5 hours by cab. ■2,000–2,800. Day trip possible. Combine both

COMPLETE MP PILGRIMAGE CIRCUIT FROM UJJAIN

DAY	ITINERARY	HIGHLIGHTS
Day 1	Arrive Ujjain · Evening Ram Ghat Aarti	Kaal Bhairav · Mangalnath · Shipra bath
Day 2	4AM Bhasma Aarti · Mahakaleshwar · Harsiddhi	Sandipani Ashram · Gadkalika · Bada Ganesh
Day 3	Day trip to Nalkheda (100 km)	Maa Baglamukhi darshan · Hawan booking · Lakhundar
Day 4	Day trip to Omkareshwar (130 km)	Jyotirlinga darshan · Boat parikrama · Narmada aarti
Day 5	Depart via Indore airport or Ujjain station	Optional: Mahakaleshwar morning darshan before leaving

BUDGET ESTIMATE (PER PERSON)

Cab (Full circuit 5 days)	■6,000–10,000 (shared ÷ group size)
Hotels (4 nights Ujjain)	■1,200–4,000 total
Bhasma Aarti booking	■250 per person
Nalkheda Hawan	■2,450 (■350 + ■2,100 dakshina)
Food (pure veg, 5 days)	■1,500–2,500
Omkareshwar boat parikrama	■50–100
Prasad + misc	■500–1,000
Total estimate	■12,000–20,300 per person

WHERE TO STAY IN UJJAIN

Hotel Shipra Residency	Near Mahakaleshwar. AC rooms, pure veg restaurant, rooftop Shipra view. ■■1,500–3,000/night
Hotel Malwa Residency	Budget AC hotel, 10 min walk from temple. ■800–1,500/night.
Dharamshala options	Multiple dharamshalas near temple — free to ■500/night on donation basis. Book in advance
Booking.com	Best hotel deals: nalkheda.in → Hotels section → Booking.com link
MakeMyTrip	Compare all options: nalkheda.in → Hotels section → MMT link

ESSENTIAL UJJAIN YATRA TIPS

- Book Bhasma Aarti online at mahakaleshwar.com at least 15 days in advance — slots fill up fast.
- Wear yellow or saffron clothes for Mahakaleshwar and Harsiddhi temple — considered auspicious.
- Download the Mahakaleshwar app for live darshan queue status and booking.
- Kaal Bhairav temple — do not be shocked by the liquor offering — it is an ancient tradition.
- Take an early morning dip at Ram Ghat (5AM–6AM) before Mahakaleshwar darshan.
- Photography is strictly prohibited inside the Mahakaleshwar sanctum.
- Carry sufficient cash — many small temple shops and dharamshalas don't accept UPI.
- Avoid visiting during Sawan (July–August) and Navratri — massive crowds, plan 3 months ahead.
- Eat only pure veg satvik food during the yatra — available at all dhabas near the temple.
- For cab, hotel, and yatra help: WhatsApp +91 97547 09571 (nalkheda.in)

Ujjain Complete Pilgrimage Guide

Published by nalkheda.in
Your complete MP pilgrimage resource

Also visit:

- nalkheda.in — Maa Baglamukhi Mandir Guide
- ✍️ ■ ektravelbuddy.netlify.app — MP Road Trip Itineraries

Cab Booking · Hotel Help · Yatra Planning:

WhatsApp: +91 97547 09571

Jai Mahakal! Jai Maa Harsiddhi! ■